LESSON 5

Prayer, Scripture & Whole-Person Wellness

Spirit • Soul • Body • Biblical Encouragement

Course: NHMEC Biblical Herbalism Foundations
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Lesson: Lesson 5
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Lesson Overview

In Lesson 1, we learned that Biblical Herbalism begins with God as Creator. In Lesson 2, we learned what it means to be a Christian herbalist. In Lesson 3, we studied discernment and spiritual boundaries. In Lesson 4, we studied the Good Samaritan model of compassion, mercy, and practical care.

In this lesson, we will focus on the place of **prayer, scripture, and whole-person wellness** in Biblical Herbalism.

Christian herbalism is not only about herbs. It is not only about teas, tinctures, salves, foods, oils, or preparations. Christian herbalism must remember that people are whole beings created by God. A person is not just a body. A person has a spirit, a soul, and a body.

Because of this, Christian herbal education must be handled with wisdom, compassion, prayer, scripture, safety, and proper boundaries.

Prayer does not replace wisdom.
Scripture does not replace medical care.
Herbs do not replace God.
Education does not replace licensed healthcare.
Whole-person wellness does not ignore the body.
Spiritual encouragement does not shame the suffering.

A Christian herbalist must learn to support people with humility, truth, compassion, and responsible care.

Lesson Scripture Foundations

1 Thessalonians 5:23 KJV

“And the very God of peace sanctify you wholly; and I pray God your whole spirit and soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.”

James 5:14–15 KJV

“Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord:
And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up…”

Proverbs 17:22 KJV

“A merry heart doeth good like a medicine: but a broken spirit drieth the bones.”

Psalm 103:2–3 KJV

“Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits:
Who forgiveth all thine iniquities; who healeth all thy diseases.”

Matthew 11:28–30 KJV

“Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.
Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart:
and ye shall find rest unto your souls.
For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.”

Philippians 4:6–7 KJV

“Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.
And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.”

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Explain the importance of prayer in Christian herbal education.
2. Describe how scripture can encourage whole-person wellness.
3. Identify spirit, soul, and body as parts of biblical whole-person care.
4. Understand that prayer and scripture must not be used to manipulate or shame others.
5. Explain why God is the ultimate healer.

6. Recognize the difference between spiritual encouragement and medical advice.
7. Practice safe, compassionate, faith-centered language in wellness education.

Opening Teaching

Christian herbalism must begin with the understanding that God cares about the whole person.

God cares about the spirit.
God cares about the soul.
God cares about the body.
God cares about the weary.
God cares about the wounded.
God cares about the fearful.
God cares about the sick.
God cares about the brokenhearted.
God cares about the person behind the problem.

A Christian herbalist must never reduce a person to symptoms, labels, conditions, or complaints. People are created in the image of God. Each person has value, dignity, history, emotions, struggles, needs, and a soul that matters to God.

This is why prayer and scripture are important in Biblical Herbalism. Prayer keeps the herbalist dependent on God. Scripture keeps the work rooted in truth. Whole-person wellness keeps the student from seeing the body as disconnected from the heart, mind, spirit, relationships, habits, and daily life.

However, prayer and scripture must be used with humility.

A Christian herbalist must never use prayer as pressure.
A Christian herbalist must never use scripture as a weapon.
A Christian herbalist must never blame every illness on sin.
A Christian herbalist must never tell a suffering person they lack faith.
A Christian herbalist must never promise healing outcomes.
A Christian herbalist must never replace medical care with spiritual language.

Prayer and scripture should bring comfort, wisdom, peace, hope, and encouragement.

They should point people to God, not to shame.

God Is the Ultimate Healer

One of the foundations of Christian herbalism is this truth:

God is the ultimate healer.

This means healing belongs to God. Wisdom belongs to God. Life belongs to God. The body was created by God, and every process of restoration ultimately depends on Him.

Herbs may support.
Food may nourish.
Rest may restore.
Prayer may comfort.
Scripture may strengthen.
Doctors may treat.
Community may support.
But God is the healer.

A Christian herbalist must keep this order clear.

When we forget this, herbs can become idols. Knowledge can become pride. Ministry can become performance. Wellness can become fear-based. Products can become the focus. The student can begin to trust created things more than the Creator.

The Christian herbalist should always remember:

We do not heal people.
We do not save people.
We do not control outcomes.
We do not replace God.
We do not replace medical care.
We serve, teach, pray, encourage, and steward what God has placed in our hands.

This keeps the work humble and safe.

Prayer in Christian Herbalism

Prayer is one of the most important practices of the Christian herbal student.

Prayer is not magic.
Prayer is not manipulation.
Prayer is not a formula.
Prayer is not a performance.
Prayer is not a way to control God.
Prayer is relationship with God.

When a Christian herbalist prays, they are acknowledging dependence on the Lord. They are asking for wisdom, discernment, humility, compassion, and guidance.

Prayer may be used:

Before studying herbs
Before teaching a lesson
Before preparing a class
Before meeting with a client or student
Before creating an educational handout
Before making a wellness suggestion
Before reading unfamiliar herbal resources
Before gathering or preparing herbs
Before serving in ministry
When someone asks for prayer
When someone is discouraged
When wisdom is needed

Prayer helps the Christian herbalist slow down and remember that the person in front of them belongs to God.

Prayer also helps the herbalist avoid pride.

A Christian herbalist should pray:

“Lord, give me wisdom.”
“Lord, help me speak truthfully.”
“Lord, keep me within my role.”
“Lord, help me not overstep.”
“Lord, show me when to refer.”
“Lord, help me serve with compassion.”
“Lord, let this work honor You.”

Prayer With Permission

When working with others, prayer should be offered respectfully.

A Christian herbalist may say:

“Would you like me to pray with you?”
“May I include you in prayer?”
“Would it be okay if we begin with prayer?”
“I can pray for wisdom as we walk through this education.”
“I am happy to pray with you, if you are comfortable.”

Prayer should not be forced.

Some people may not be ready. Some may be hurting. Some may be processing trauma. Some may have had painful religious experiences. Some may be in fear or confusion. The Christian herbalist should be gentle.

The goal is not to perform spirituality. The goal is to show Christlike compassion.

Prayer should be:

Humble
Kind
Simple
Biblical
Peaceful
Respectful
Christ-centered

Prayer should not be:

Controlling
Loud for attention
Used to shame
Used to manipulate
Used to promise outcomes
Used to replace medical care
Used to pressure someone into agreement

Christian herbalists should pray with wisdom and love.

Scripture in Christian Herbalism

Scripture is the foundation of Biblical Herbalism because Scripture gives us truth, boundaries, wisdom, correction, comfort, and hope.

The Bible is not an herbal encyclopedia, but it does show us God's care for the whole person. It teaches us about creation, food, rest, wisdom, prayer, compassion, healing, obedience, mercy, and stewardship.

Scripture helps the Christian herbal student remember:

God created the earth.
God provides food from the earth.
The body matters.
The heart matters.
The mind matters.
Rest matters.
Wisdom matters.
Words matter.
Compassion matters.
God is the healer.

Scripture can be used in herbal education for encouragement and reflection. For example:

Genesis 1:29 can remind students that God provided seed-bearing herbs and fruit-bearing trees for food.
Psalm 104:14 can remind students that God causes herbs to grow for the service of man.
1 Corinthians 6:19–20 can remind students to steward the body as the temple of the Holy Ghost.
Proverbs 17:22 can remind students that the condition of the heart can affect the whole person.
Matthew 11:28–30 can remind weary people that Jesus gives rest to the soul.

Scripture should be handled carefully and respectfully.

A Christian herbalist should not twist scripture to sell products, prove exaggerated claims, or make promises that God has not authorized them to make.

Scripture as Encouragement, Not Condemnation

One of the dangers in Christian wellness work is using scripture in a way that burdens people instead of helping them.

A person who is sick may already feel afraid.
A person with chronic illness may already feel exhausted.
A person with grief may already feel broken.
A person under stress may already feel overwhelmed.
A person seeking help may already feel ashamed.

The Christian herbalist must be careful not to add condemnation.

Do not say:

“You are sick because you lack faith.”
“If you prayed more, you would be healed.”
“This happened because of your sin.”
“Real Christians do not need medicine.”
“If you trusted God, you would not be afraid.”
“You should be healed by now.”

These statements can wound people deeply.

Instead, say:

“God sees you.”
“You are not alone.”
“Let’s pray for wisdom and strength.”
“God cares about what you are walking through.”
“It is okay to seek proper care.”

“Let’s take one wise step at a time.”
“God is faithful even in the process.”

Scripture should bring people closer to God, not make them feel pushed away.

Whole-Person Wellness

Whole-person wellness recognizes that the spirit, soul, and body are connected.

This does not mean that every physical illness has a spiritual cause. It does not mean we blame the person. It does not mean we ignore medical science. It means that human beings are complex, and care should be thoughtful.

A person may need physical support.
A person may need emotional support.
A person may need spiritual encouragement.
A person may need food.
A person may need sleep.
A person may need prayer.
A person may need a doctor.
A person may need counseling.
A person may need community.
A person may need safety.

Whole-person wellness asks:

What is happening in the body?
What is happening in the soul?
What is happening spiritually?
What daily habits may need support?
What burdens is this person carrying?
What resources are needed?
What is outside my role?
Where is God inviting wisdom, order, rest, and stewardship?

This approach helps the Christian herbalist see the whole person while staying within proper boundaries.

The Spirit

The spirit relates to a person’s relationship with God.

Spiritual wellness may include:

Faith
Prayer
Worship
Scripture
Repentance
Forgiveness
Hope
Trust
Identity in Christ
Peace with God
Spiritual community

A Christian herbalist may encourage spiritual wellness by pointing people toward God's Word, prayer, worship, pastoral support, and faith in Christ.

However, the Christian herbalist must not assume they know everything about a person's spiritual condition. Only God knows the heart fully.

The Christian herbalist may ask gentle questions such as:

"Would prayer be helpful for you?"
"Are there scriptures that bring you comfort?"
"Do you have spiritual support right now?"
"Would you like encouragement from the Word?"
"Is there a burden you would like prayer for?"

Spiritual support should be offered with humility and care.

The Soul

The soul includes the mind, will, emotions, thoughts, choices, memory, and inner life.

Many people carry soul burdens.

They may carry:

Fear
Stress
Grief
Anger
Rejection
Shame
Anxiety
Overwhelm
Sadness

Bitterness
Confusion
Exhaustion
Disappointment

These burdens can influence daily choices, sleep, appetite, relationships, motivation, and the ability to care for the body.

A Christian herbalist is not automatically a licensed counselor. Unless legally trained and licensed, the herbalist must not provide mental health treatment. However, the Christian herbalist can listen compassionately, encourage rest, provide scripture encouragement, suggest journaling, recommend pastoral care, and refer to a qualified counselor or crisis resource when needed.

Soul care may include:

Prayer journaling
Scripture meditation
Gratitude practice
Forgiveness work with pastoral support
Rest routines
Peaceful rhythms
Encouraging community
Wise counsel
Licensed counseling when needed
Reducing overwhelm
Learning to speak truth over fear

A Christian herbalist should never shame emotional pain. Jesus was compassionate toward the brokenhearted.

The Body

The body includes physical health and daily habits.

Body stewardship may include:

Food
Water
Rest
Sleep
Movement
Sunlight
Breathing
Digestion
Elimination

Hygiene
Herbal teas
Kitchen herbs
Nourishing meals
Gentle routines
Medical care when needed

A Christian herbalist may teach people how to support the body with general wellness education. This may include simple herbs, foods, and lifestyle practices.

However, the Christian herbalist must remember:

The body can have real medical needs.
Pain can have serious causes.
Symptoms should not be ignored.
Herbs can interact with medications.
Pregnancy and childhood require extra caution.
Emergency symptoms require emergency care.
Medical providers have an important role.

Christian herbalism should not teach people to neglect the body in the name of faith. Caring for the body can be an act of stewardship.

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ Connection

Within NHMEC, whole-person wellness can be understood through the **Holistic P.E.N. Way™**:

P — Perspective: Spirit
How does the person see God, themselves, their body, and their situation?

E — Essence: Soul
What is happening in the mind, emotions, choices, identity, stress, and inner life?

N — Nutrition: Body
How is the person nourishing, supporting, and stewarding the physical body?

This framework helps students remember that Christian wellness education should not focus only on herbs. Herbs may be one part of support, but they are not the whole picture.

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ asks:

What needs to be renewed in perspective?
What needs to be restored in the soul?
What needs to be nourished in the body?

This keeps the Christian herbal student rooted in whole-person care.

Prayer, Scripture & Herbs Working in Proper Order

A Christian herbal student must learn proper order.

The order is not:

Herbs first.
Products first.
Protocols first.
Claims first.
Fear first.

The order is:

God first.
Prayer for wisdom.
Scripture for foundation.
Compassion for the person.
Safety for the body.
Education within scope.
Referral when needed.
Herbs as supportive tools, not saviors.

Herbs may be included as part of general wellness education, but they must never take the place of God, wisdom, safety, or proper care.

A Christian herbalist might say:

“Let’s pray for wisdom first.”
“Let’s look at what scripture says about stewardship and rest.”
“Let’s consider what your body may need in terms of nourishment and support.”
“Let’s talk about safe traditional uses of this herb.”
“Let’s make sure this is not something that needs medical attention.”
“Let’s use careful educational language.”

This order protects the student and honors God.

When Prayer and Medical Care Work Together

Some people believe that if they pray, they should not seek medical care. Others believe that if they seek medical care, they are not walking in faith. Biblical Herbalism should not teach either extreme.

Prayer and medical care are not enemies.

A person can pray and see a doctor.
A person can trust God and take medication.
A person can read scripture and receive emergency care.
A person can use herbs carefully and follow medical advice.
A person can believe God heals and still use wisdom.

The Christian herbalist should not shame people for receiving medical care.

A safe statement is:

“We believe God is the healer, and we also believe wisdom includes seeking appropriate care when needed.”

This protects students from giving harmful advice and protects suffering people from unnecessary guilt.

Red Flags That Require Referral

A Christian herbalist must know when a person needs immediate medical attention or professional support.

Refer urgently or encourage emergency care for:

Chest pain
Difficulty breathing
Severe allergic reaction
Severe bleeding
Possible stroke symptoms
Severe abdominal pain
High fever with concerning symptoms
Seizure
Severe dehydration
Serious injury
Confusion or loss of consciousness
Suicidal thoughts or self-harm risk
Pregnancy complications
Severe infection signs
Poisoning
Severe burns
Sudden weakness or numbness

A Christian herbalist should also refer to appropriate licensed care for:

Medication questions
Chronic disease management
Severe mental health symptoms

Eating disorders
Domestic violence
Substance abuse
Persistent or worsening symptoms
Children, elders, pregnancy, or medically fragile individuals
Complex medical conditions

Referral is not a lack of faith.

Referral is wisdom.

Safe Faith-Centered Language

The Christian herbalist must learn to speak in a way that honors God and protects people.

Instead of saying:

“God told me this herb will heal you.”

Say:

“Let’s pray for wisdom and discuss this herb from an educational perspective.”

Instead of saying:

“You do not need medicine if you have faith.”

Say:

“Faith and wisdom can work together. Please consult your healthcare provider for medical decisions.”

Instead of saying:

“This scripture proves this herb cures disease.”

Say:

“This scripture reminds us that God created plants and cares about healing, but we must avoid making claims beyond what is written or supported.”

Instead of saying:

“You are sick because you are spiritually weak.”

Say:

“God cares about you, and we can seek Him for strength, wisdom, and support.”

Instead of saying:

“This protocol will fix you.”

Say:

“This educational plan may support general wellness habits, but it is not a diagnosis or treatment plan.”

Safe language is part of Christian love.

Creating Scripture & Wellness Encouragement

One way Christian herbal students can serve is by creating scripture-based encouragement sheets.

These can include:

A scripture
A short reflection
A prayer
A simple stewardship action
A reminder to seek proper care when needed

Example:

Scripture: Matthew 11:28 KJV
“Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.”

Reflection:
Jesus invites the weary to come to Him. Rest is not weakness. Rest can be part of obedience and stewardship.

Prayer:
Lord, teach me to receive Your rest and walk in wisdom today.

Stewardship Step:
Take ten quiet minutes today to breathe, pray, hydrate, and step away from unnecessary noise.

This kind of resource encourages faith and practical wellness without making medical claims.

Teacher’s Teaching Notes

When teaching this lesson, emphasize balance.

Students may come from different backgrounds. Some may believe prayer is all that is needed and may feel suspicious of medical care. Others may feel uncomfortable praying with people. Some may have seen scripture used harshly. Some may be learning for the first time how spirit, soul, and body connect.

Teach that prayer is powerful, but it is not manipulation. Scripture is foundational, but it must not be twisted. Herbs can support wellness, but they are not saviors. Medical care can be necessary, and seeking care is not a lack of faith.

Students should leave this lesson understanding that Christian herbalism must be both spiritual and responsible.

The goal is not to choose between faith and wisdom.

The goal is to walk in faith-filled wisdom.

Student Reflection

Answer the following questions in your notebook or student workbook.

1. What does whole-person wellness mean to you?
2. How does 1 Thessalonians 5:23 shape your understanding of spirit, soul, and body?
3. Why is prayer important in Christian herbal education?
4. How can scripture encourage someone without condemning them?
5. Why should a Christian herbalist avoid promising healing outcomes?
6. How can herbs become an idol if they are placed above God?
7. How can medical care and prayer work together?
8. What is one safe faith-centered phrase you can use when teaching herbal education?
9. Why is referral an act of wisdom and compassion?
10. How can the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ help you remember the whole person?

Vocabulary Words

Prayer: Communication with God through worship, request, thanksgiving, confession, surrender, and dependence.

Scripture: The written Word of God and the foundation for Christian truth, wisdom, correction, and encouragement.

Whole-Person Wellness: A Christian wellness perspective that considers spirit, soul, and body.

Spirit: The part of a person relating to relationship with God, faith, worship, prayer, and spiritual life.

Soul: The mind, will, emotions, thoughts, choices, memory, and inner life.

Body Stewardship: Responsible care for the physical body through nourishment, rest, wise habits, and proper care.

Referral: Directing someone to appropriate licensed, pastoral, emergency, or professional support when the need is outside your role.

Faith-Filled Wisdom: Trusting God while also walking in safety, discernment, responsibility, and practical care.

Lesson 5 Summary

Prayer, scripture, and whole-person wellness are essential parts of Biblical Herbalism. A Christian herbalist recognizes that people are created by God as whole beings with spirit, soul, and body. Because of this, herbal education must be compassionate, safe, prayerful, and rooted in biblical truth.

Prayer helps the Christian herbalist depend on God for wisdom. Scripture provides foundation, encouragement, and correction. Herbs may support general wellness, but they must never replace God, medical care, or wise stewardship.

Christian herbalists must not use prayer or scripture to shame, pressure, manipulate, or promise outcomes. Instead, they should use prayer and scripture to comfort, strengthen, encourage, and point people back to God.

Remember:

God is the healer.
Prayer brings dependence on God.
Scripture brings truth and encouragement.
The person is spirit, soul, and body.
Herbs are supportive tools, not saviors.
Medical care may be necessary.
Referral is wisdom.
Compassion must guide the work.

Closing Prayer

Father God,

Thank You for caring about the whole person. Thank You for seeing the spirit, soul, and body. Teach me to walk in wisdom as I study Biblical Herbalism. Help me use prayer with humility, scripture with truth, and herbal education with safety.

Keep me from pride, fear, manipulation, exaggeration, and careless words. Help me never shame those who are suffering. Teach me to encourage, comfort, listen, and refer when needed.

Let my work honor You. Let my words bring peace. Let my studies be rooted in Your Word. Let everything I learn point back to You as the ultimate healer.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Instructor Closing

Students, prayer and scripture are not decorations added to Christian herbalism. They are part of the foundation. But they must be handled with humility and love.

The person in front of you is not just a body. They are not just a symptom. They are not just a case. They are a person created by God with a spirit, soul, and body.

As Christian herbal students, we must learn to pray, study, listen, teach, and serve with wisdom.

Do not use scripture to shame.
Do not use prayer to pressure.
Do not use herbs to replace God.
Do not use wellness education to replace medical care.

Pray with humility.
Speak with compassion.
Teach with safety.
Encourage with scripture.
Refer with wisdom.
Keep Christ at the center.

This is whole-person Biblical Herbalism.